

Bazaar

QUICK
INSIGHTS
FROM INDEPTH
TESTS

The Digit Test Centre receives hundreds of products every month. Each of these products is put through a series of tests, and are finally given a verdict. The final score is arrived at after considering a number of factors and evaluating them in terms of features, performance, value for money, build quality, and in the case of software, even ease of use.

For better understanding of our ratings, here's a quick guide to our overall score

1.0 - 3.0 - Extremely poor product. Keep away!

3.5 - 5.0 - Strictly OK. Not recommended

5.5 - 6.5 - Decent product. Go for it, but there may be better products.

7.0 - 8.5 - Very good product. Highly recommended.

9.0-10.0 - Ground-breaking product. We've never seen anything like it before. A definite must buy!



Run Linux on a browser

Try out some Linux commands on your favourite web browser
<http://bit.ly/izgxsc>

MOTHERBOARD



ECS HDC-I2

Price: ₹5,900



Zotac H67-ITX

Price: ₹7,200

SPECIFICATIONS

Form Factor.....Mini-ITX
CPU.....AMD E350 1.6-GHz
GPU.....ATI Radeon HD6310
RAM Support.....DDR3 800/1066MHz

Form Factor.....Mini-ITX
Socket.....LGA1155
Max RAM Supported.....16 GB
RAM Speed.....1333 MHz

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All scores out of 10)

Features.....6.5

The ECS HDC-I2 isn't feature-rich – takes care of the basics, but nothing out of the box.

Performance.....6.5

The board's performance can be summed up as average. Its PC Mark Vantage score of 2,542 isn't much different.

Build quality.....6.0

Ordinary build quality, typical ports placement, nothing great to talk about here.

Value for money.....7.5

The HDC-I2 is a good bargain for a basic HTPC board with a compact form factor.

Features.....8.5

For a mini-ITX board, the Zotac H67 packs in virtually every connectivity feature imaginable.

Performance.....7.5

The Zotac H67-ITX board performed at par with previously tested H67 ATX boards. Crysis played well at medium settings.

Build quality.....7.0

Nothing much to complain here. The Zotac H67 has well designed, well laid out circuits.

Value for money.....7.0

The Zotac H67-ITX is priced similar to most Intel H67 boards available in the market.

WE SAY

6.5

The ECS HDC-I2 is a basic mini-ITX board sporting an AMD Brazos E-350 APU with onboard DX11 graphics, making it an HTPC contender for your home. The board isn't in the class of the ASUS E35M1-I Deluxe we reviewed last month, in terms of features and build quality. The HDC-I2 doesn't have a Wi-Fi adapter, no HDMI port and concentrates solely on striking a balance between price and performance for a budget-conscious HTPC user.

7.0

A mini-ITX motherboard, the ZOTAC H67-ITX is a pint-sized warrior, giving its larger ATX-sized counterparts a good run for their money. It comes with an impressive array of features: Wi-Fi 802.11n, DVI, HDMI, eSATA, USB 3.0, USB 2.0, SATA III, SATA II, Display Port and other connectivity ports. Expansion slots are a problem because of the form factor rather than anything else. We liked the board's performance overall. It is priced well and recommended for usage, ranging from a basic HTPC to a mid-range media rig – albeit with a small size.